



CSE332

INDUSTRY ETHICS AND LEGAL ISSUES



Intellectual property rights

- Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) are legal rights.
- It protect and encourage the development and distribution of new products and services.
- IPRs are granted to people over their creations.
- Such as inventions, designs, trademarks, and creative content.



Copyright

- Copyright is a legal right that protects the original work of a creator. It prevents others from copying, sharing, or using it without permission.
- Protects **original works**: books, music, movies, paintings, software, etc.
- Gives the creator the **exclusive right** to use, copy, or sell the work.
- Automatically exists when a work is created; registration is optional but helpful.
- Usually lasts for the **life of the creator + 50-70 years** depending on the country.
- Examples:
 - A novel by **J.K. Rowling**
 - A song by **Taylor Swift**
 - Software like **Microsoft Word**

Things take place under copyrights

- Novels
- Art
- Poetry
- Musical lyrics and compositions
- Films
- Website content



Trademark

- A trademark is a symbol, word, or design that identifies a product or service and distinguishes it from others in the market.
- Protects **brand identity**, not creative works.
- Can be **registered** for extra protection.
- Helps customers recognize and trust a brand.
- Examples
 - Nike's swoosh logo
 - The word **Coca-Cola**

Trade Secrete

- A trade secret is confidential business information that gives a company a **competitive advantage**. Unlike patents, it is **not publicly disclosed**.
 - Must be **secret**: only known to a few people in the company.
 - Must have **commercial value** because it is secret.
 - The company must take **reasonable steps to keep it secret** (e.g., NDAs, locked files).
 - No formal registration is needed; protection lasts **as long as the secret is maintained**.
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- **Coca-Cola formula** – no one outside the company knows it.
 - **Google search algorithm** – confidential to maintain competitive edge.
 - **KFC's secret spice mix** – recipe kept hidden for decades.



Brand Names

A name used to identify a product or company.

Helps customers recognize a product easily.

Example: Pepsi, Samsung, Nike

Logos

A visual symbol or design that represents a brand.

Often more memorable than just a name; unique graphic design.

Example: McDonald's Golden Arches, Apple's apple logo

Signatures

Personal mark of an individual, usually used in art or documents.

Shows authorship and authenticity

Example: Picasso's signature on a painting, author signatures in books

Geographical Indication

- A geographical indication (GI) is a name or sign that identifies a product's geographical origin.
- GIs are used to certify that products are made in a specific place using traditional methods.



- GIs help consumers identify quality products.
- GIs help producers market their products.
- GIs prevent other people from using popular product names.

Design

It protects the visual appearance of a product or part of it.

Design rights protect the unique look of a product, including its shape, color, pattern, texture, and materials.



Plant varieties

“PVRs protect breeders from unauthorized reproduction, production, marketing, selling, importing, and exporting of their plant varieties.”

